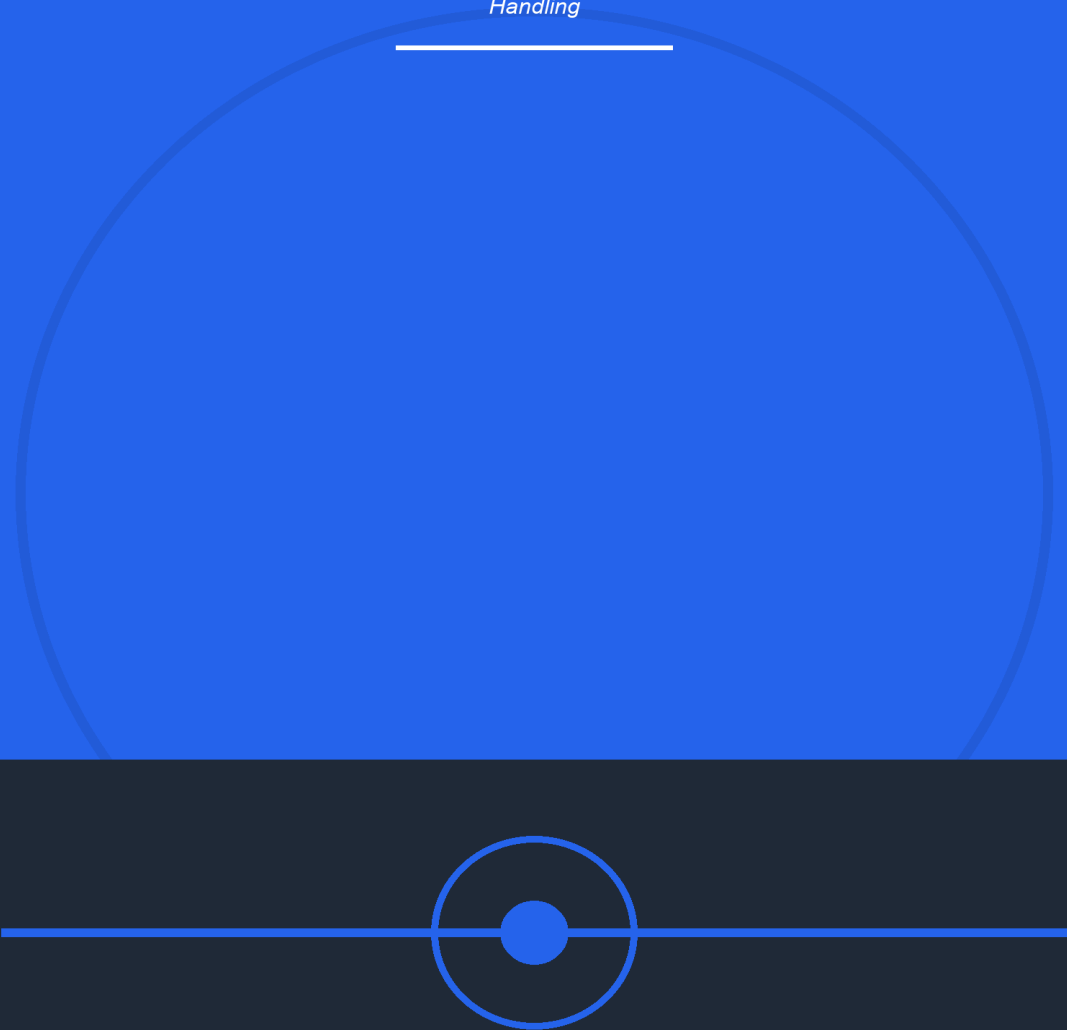


WORKFLOW AUTOMATION SYSTEM FOR LOGISTICS COMPANIES

A Practical Implementation Blueprint for Automating Dispatch Updates and Exception Handling



OPENCLAW PRESS

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Overview

This is an implementation blueprint, not installed software: a method for logistics and freight companies to automate the repetitive parts of dispatch coordination and shipment tracking, using workflow-automation tools you already have or can add cheaply, connected to your carriers' and dispatch systems' existing data.

The real problem: dispatchers and ops staff at small-to-mid logistics companies spend a large share of their day manually checking tracking status, updating customers, and re-routing around delays or damage reports - work that follows the same few patterns every time.

This blueprint sets up three things: a scheduled pull of tracking/status updates from carriers you already work with, an automation that flags real exceptions (late, damaged, missing) instead of routine on-time shipments, and a plain-language summary an ops person can act on in seconds instead of digging through a dashboard.

What this is not: not a hosted dispatch platform, not a replacement for your dispatch software, and not a fully unattended system - every exception it flags should still be reviewed and actioned by a real person.

Getting Started

Step 1 - List which carriers/systems you already use that offer a tracking export or API (most major carriers do).

Step 2 - Pick ONE exception type to start with - late shipments are usually the highest-volume, clearest pattern.

Step 3 - Set up a scheduled workflow (n8n or Zapier) that pulls tracking status for active shipments on a fixed interval.

Step 4 - Add a simple rule that flags any shipment past its expected delivery window, and generate a short summary of what's late and by how much.

Step 5 - Route that summary to your ops channel (email, Slack, or your existing dispatch tool) instead of requiring anyone to check a dashboard manually.

Step 6 - Add damaged/missing-shipment detection only once the late-shipment flow is reliable for two full weeks.

Feature Reference

Four real building blocks, using tools you choose and control.

1. Status Collectors - scheduled pulls from your carriers' existing tracking APIs or exports, no new carrier relationships required.
 2. Exception Detector - a simple rule set that flags shipments outside their expected window, rather than surfacing every on-time shipment as noise.
 3. Ops Summary Generator - an AI prompt that turns a batch of flagged exceptions into a short, prioritized list an ops person can act on immediately.
 4. Customer Update Draft - an optional step that drafts (never auto-sends without review) a plain-language delay notice your team can approve and send to affected customers.
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Setup & Configuration

What you need: a workflow-automation account (n8n self-hosted or Zapier), read access to your carriers' tracking data, and an AI API key for the summary step.

A minimal first workflow: scheduled trigger, pull tracking status, flag anything past its expected window, summarize the flagged list, post it to your ops channel.

Security note: tracking-data access should be read-only; this workflow never needs to modify a shipment or a carrier account.

Run the late-shipment flow alone for two weeks before adding damage/loss detection.

FAQ & Troubleshooting

Does this replace my dispatch software? No. It sits alongside it, surfacing exceptions your team would otherwise have to find manually.

Is this installed software? No. It is a workflow you set up using tools you already choose and control - no OpenClaw platform is involved in running it.

What if a customer-update draft sounds wrong? Never auto-send it. Always have a real person review and approve before anything goes to a customer.

How do I know it's helping? Compare the time your ops team spends manually checking tracking before and after - that time saved is the real, honest measure of value.

Support & Next Steps

Start with late-shipment detection for your highest-volume carrier this week.

This blueprint does not include dispatch software, carrier contracts, or a support team from OpenClaw - every tool referenced is one you sign up for and control yourself.

Success here means fewer manual status checks and faster exception response, not a guarantee this document does not and cannot make.